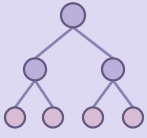
ELIZA (1966)
Prolog, Cyc

TREC QA (1999)
Web search
SQuAD (2016)

Transformer
BERT, GPT-2/3
T5

ReAct (2022/2023)
GPT-4, Gemini (2023)

1960s onward



Symbolic approaches

Rules & logic
Knowledge representation

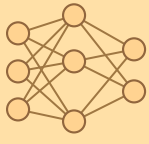
1990s onward



Retrieval & reading comprehension

Document retrieval
Answer extraction

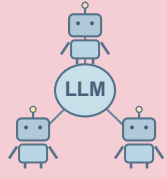
2010s onward



Neural & generative QA

Pretraining & fine-tuning
RAG (2020), CoT (2022)

2022 onward



LLM-based agentic QA

Tool use
Multi-agent collaboration

Representative milestones; paradigms overlap and continue to coexist.